

Student Resource:

Deferral Guide

Note: the following reading is of medium length. It should take about 8 minutes and give you a balanced perspective on what a “deferral” means and how to manage next steps!

What does it mean to be “deferred?”

When you are deferred, it means that the school has not yet made a final decision on the application; instead, your application will be moved to the Regular Decision applicant pool, to be reviewed again alongside the rest of the RD pool.

Deferrals happen for many reasons—most often, it’s because the school does not yet have enough information to either accept or reject the deferred student. Other common reasons include:

- The student’s academic record is inconsistent; the college may want to see midyear grades before making a decision
- The college wants to wait to review the RD applicant pool before making a final decision, to compare the student against other applicants from their local context

What should I do now?

- Keep calm, remembering that you still have a chance and that Crimson will continue to support you!
- Pay attention to the instructions sent to you by the college and follow the timeline/deadline/steps laid out, especially as it relates to sending an official academic update.
- Inform your college counselor, who will need to send in your midyear report (Northern Hemisphere school year) or midyear/final report (Southern Hemisphere school year) by early January.
- Your Strategist can help you decide whether to send a deferral letter/letter of continued interest (which includes updates and a reaffirmation of interest). These letters are typically sent in late December/early January, but only after you’ve submitted RD applications!
 - o All deferred students should send this letter, unless:
 - You are no longer interested in attending the college.
 - You want to focus your time elsewhere

How do I write a great letter of continued interest?



- Consider the deferral letter/letter of continued interest as an opportunity to pass on new information that could strengthen your application, such as improved test scores, a new achievement/award, a new leadership position, or a new internship/research publication.
- Brainstorm new content that would add value to your existing application, double checking the school's specific policy/instructions for deferred candidates.
- Keep the tone positive and grateful: you should reaffirm your interest in the school and should not display any disappointment, anger, or frustration in the letter. Be careful not to point fingers or suggest that the admissions officials made a mistake.
- Stay consistent with your Personal Statement and/or supplements when it comes to grammar, punctuation, tone, and style.
- Remember: writing this letter may not improve your chances of being admitted.
- Once you and your Strategist outline the letter, you should work with your App Mentor to draft and edit the letter such that it reiterates how much you are interested in the university and presents new information that might boost your candidacy.
- Below are successful examples of past Crimson students who have submitted their deferral letter and were eventually admitted during the RD round.

Example #1 - Deferred ED, then Accepted to Wharton RD

I would like to begin by thanking the admissions committee for offering me the opportunity to be considered to attend the University. While many things have changed since I first sent my application, the most important aspect of it remains the same: my top-choice school is still the University, in particular, the School of Business.

In December, I graduated high school and received my IB exam results, which totaled XX out of 45 points. Though I was slightly disappointed with some of the grades I received, I know I did my best and worked very hard. Now, I am using what I learned through my IB and college application experience to help younger students at my high school in their respective journeys. I aim to continue tutoring these students after I move to attend college, too.

Given my senior year performance, my high school awarded me five certificates: one for outstanding performance in Biology; one for excellent academic performance in Biology, Portuguese, and Spanish, respectively; and a fifth one for effort in History, for which I felt especially proud since I was not expecting that many certificates because each of them can only be given to one student per grade.

After graduating in December, I finished my other college applications, and my holidays began. My TV show hiatus finally came to an end! I could catch up on all of the shows I had on hold and even discovered a new interest: documentaries about sea life. Although my TV habit may seem superficial, I would like to highlight that I am still learning! I have watched TV shows in Portuguese, English, Spanish, and even Italian,



which has helped me further practice my language skills. I have also learned that 1) contrary to popular thought, Klaus Mikaelson is indeed destructible, 2) Lucifer Morningstar always wins (no matter what), and 3) Shonda Rhimes never ceases to surprise me.

Beginning in February, I will be interning with The Sound, the National record label, which is strongly related to what I plan for my future career: working in the entertainment industry. At The Sound, I'll learn about the marketing strategies behind a song or an artist and the way music and its marketing can influence a specific public. Moreover, the experience I will gain in the music business field will help me feel more prepared for college and life thereafter. I will witness first-hand how the industry works and will be able to share my own experience with my peers.

Outside of my internship, I will be taking a Japanese language course to improve my Japanese speaking, reading, and writing skills. I also aim to focus on my physical and mental health through different activities, such as sports and meditation. Regular exercise and meditation is something I sacrificed during the chaotic examination period that preceded my high school graduation. Reinstating such practice is important to me, and I know it will best serve me as I prepare for university.

It has sadly come to my attention that Professor [redacted] passed away late last year. My condolences. I was preparing to contact him and discuss my interest in the influence of images and visual culture, but I know there are equally excellent professors at the University I can work with to explore the social challenges involved in marketing and advertising.

I would like to thank you once again for your consideration and state that I will gladly enroll in the School of Business if offered a position in the class of 2023. I hope I am offered this opportunity and am able to benefit from professors and their mentorship, take advantage of the clubs and fellowships available, cheer on the Mascots, and become a part of this unique community.

Example #2 - Deferred REA to Harvard (Ultimately accepted RD to Yale)

Thank you for continuing to consider me for admission to the Class of 2023. I still wholeheartedly believe Harvard is an excellent fit for me. I know that there are many strong applicants in the Regular Decision round so I would like to use this letter as an opportunity to showcase why I am right for Harvard.

I visited campus in October 2018 and I was able to better understand Harvard's extensive academic, professional, and extracurricular offerings and how I could positively impact the Harvard community. Since my visit, I have remained in contact with Professor [redacted] in the Department of Government and Dr. [redacted], the Professor of Practice in the Media and Activism, to learn more about the topics covered stay such as the Kinsey Reports and how different governments derive their

power. I have also stayed in touch with my wonderful host [redacted] '22, and his suitemates [redacted] '22 and [redacted] '22.

I intend to take full advantage of the Government program at Harvard, as my experiences interning for Congresswoman [redacted], working at The Barrio Impact, and interning at the Bilateral Safety Corridor Coalition have established a foundation for me to build upon to be an effective force for positive change. At Harvard, I would like to be involved with the Institute of Politics, the Phillips Brooks House Association, and the Harvard Political Review. Being an active member of my community is something I've always valued, especially as the captain of my school's Quiz Bowl team and founder of the College Awareness Club, so I see myself trying new things like joining OnHarvardTime and The Harvard Lampoon.

I have not slowed down since submitting my application as I will graduate as salutatorian and I have remained politically active in the San Diego area. I was recently selected by the mayor of [redacted] , to be mentored one-on-one for my senior capstone project where I will explore my interest in government at the local level. If accepted, I intend to translate my political skills into a run for the Undergraduate Council and possibly even for Cambridge City Council. I would love to speak with [redacted] '20 about her campaign and what she felt she could have done differently. The combination of those activities and my studies at Harvard would leave me better equipped to pursue a dual JD/MBA, practice law, and then possibly hold elected office.

Again, thank you for taking more time to evaluate my application, I am grateful for this second chance. If necessary, I would be more than happy to be interviewed again or to answer more questions. Harvard remains my first-choice school, and if I am selected for admission, I will most certainly attend.

